Meanwhile, the veteran C. Vijayaraghavachari was getting his hands dirty in trying to bolster the company. Even some months earlier, running into Vithaldas Damodar Thackersey, a prominent Bombay businessman, on a train to Rameswaram for pilgrimage, he had tried to persuade him to invest in the Swadeshi company: Sir Vithaldas turned down the overtures preferring to invest in 'more remunerative ventures', such as the Bangalore–Chikkaballapur railway.[78] A busy man with a flourishing legal practice and a big role in public life, Vijayaraghavachari now took time off to tour in the Hosur division (of Salem district) trying to mobilize new shareholders.[79]

In Salem, he collected Rs 5,000, and immediately remitted it to Tuticorin.[80] He also met a shareholder Fakir Mohammed Sait, a leading merchant at Coonoor, hoping to persuade him to buy more shares, but apparently without success.[81] Vijayaraghavachari also asked the venerable Gooty P. Kesava Pillai, journalist, early nationalist and a public figure with good friends in the higher echelons of government, if 'The S.S.N.Co may not be given by you a portion of your time & attention.'[82] Vijayaraghavachari employed various means to support the company. As an accomplished lawyer commanding high fees, he once defended a *kangani* from Ceylon's upcountry tea plantation, won the case, and in lieu of fees extracted a promise that the kangani would take all indentured labourers only through the Swadeshi ship.[83] His efforts notwithstanding, it was said that—this comes from a police report though, and needs to be taken with a pinch of salt—he himself had not paid amounts that he had promised.[84]

The lawyers in Tuticorin, who had solidly backed the Swadeshi movement, too went on an overdrive. Persecution by the local administration only steeled their resolve. Though they themselves were in the crosshairs of the police, many of them had bravely appeared pro bono in defence of the accused in the 'riots' cases. Despite the palpable fear following the 'riots' and the arrests, P.L. Vengu Aiyar collected Rs 2,500 in Tirunelveli district alone.[85] Meanwhile Sadhu Ganapati Panthulu travelled in Salem in May 1908 to canvass shares.[86]